Kestrel Ridge Software: Staff handbook

Version 4.2 | Effective Monday, January 4, 2027 | Owner: People Team

1. Welcome to Kestrel Ridge

Kestrel Ridge Software builds and supports ordering, booking, and reporting apps for retailers and service businesses. We have about 140 staff, most of them at our office at 300 Larkfield Avenue, Columbus, Ohio.

This handbook covers how we work together. Four other documents cover specific topics in more detail: the Remote-Work Guide, the Travel Policy, the Expenses Policy, and the Benefits Summary. If this handbook and one of those documents differ, the more specific document applies.

2. Working hours

Our standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday. Core hours, when everyone should be available for meetings, are 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. Eastern Time. Outside core hours, you can arrange your day with your line manager.

If you need to work late or at a weekend to meet a deadline, agree it with your line manager first and take the time back within four weeks.

3. Where you work

Most roles are hybrid: some days in the office and some days at home. The number of home-working days, and how to arrange them, are set out in the Remote-Work Guide.

The office is open from 7:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. on weekdays. Your badge opens the main entrance and your team's floor. Visitors must sign in at reception and wear a visitor badge.

4. Time off

Type of leave	Allowance
Vacation	20 days a year, plus 1 extra day for each full year of service, up to 25 days
Public holidays	10 days a year. The list is published on the intranet each December.
Sick leave	10 paid days a year. Tell your line manager by 10:00 a.m. on the first day.
Parental leave	16 weeks at full pay for any new parent, after 6 months of service
Volunteering	2 paid days a year for volunteering with a registered charity

Book vacation in the HR system at least two weeks ahead for anything longer than three days. Up to 5 unused vacation days can be carried into the next year.

5. Using company equipment

- Your laptop and phone are for work. Light personal use is fine.
- Lock your screen whenever you leave your desk.
- Only install software from the company app catalog.
- Report a lost or stolen device to the IT help desk within one hour, on (614) 555-0177.

6. Using AI tools

You may use the AI assistants approved by IT, using your work account. Don't paste client data, source code, or personal information about colleagues into any tool that isn't on the approved list. If AI helped produce work for a client, check every fact, and follow the client's own rules about AI.

7. Conduct

We expect everyone to treat colleagues, clients, and visitors with respect. Harassment and discrimination aren't tolerated. If something worries you, talk to your line manager, the People Team, or the confidential helpline on (614) 555-0190.

8. The office

- The kitchen on each floor has free coffee, tea, and fruit. Please label food in the shared fridge, which is cleared every Friday at 4:00 p.m.
- Quiet rooms on floors 2 and 3 can be booked for focused work or private calls.
- Bicycle racks and showers are in the basement.
- The office is smoke-free and vape-free, including the entrance and the roof terrace.

9. Questions

Ask your line manager first. For anything about pay, leave, or benefits, contact the People Team at people@kestrelridge.example.